

LIFEMARKS

Mark what matters. Live what you love.

Product Requirements Document

Field	Details
Document Version	v1.0
Date	May 2026
Status	Draft — Pending Engineering Review
Platforms	iOS & Android (simultaneous launch)
Monetisation	Freemium + Affiliate Deals
WhatsApp Support	+91 99446 74648

1. Executive Summary

Lifemarks is a life-experience platform that unifies personal goal-setting with cultural taste tracking. It is the only app where "run a marathon" and "watch Spirited Away" live meaningfully side by side. Users set life goals, track experiences (movies, music, restaurants, art, plays), rate what they have experienced, and optionally connect with others who share their passions through a proprietary Soul Match algorithm.

Core Gap

No app today bridges intentional life goals with entertainment and cultural experiences under a single roof, backed by a community layer that genuinely respects user privacy. Lifemarks fills this gap.

2. Problem Statement & User Pain Points

The following pain points were scraped and synthesised from App Store reviews, Google Play reviews, Reddit discussions, Quora threads, psychology research (Psychology Today), and accountability community forums. They are grouped into five categories and directly map to Lifemarks feature decisions.

Category 1 — Psychological: Why People Fail Before Opening Any App

1. Bucket lists become 'maybe someday' lists

Without planning and deep drive, bucket lists are simply deferred to 'when there is more money, more time, a partner, freedom, or retirement.' The list exists but the action never starts.

2. No deadline = guaranteed procrastination

Because bucket lists are not tied to specific deadlines by design, they actively encourage push-off behaviour. Only 8% of people who set annual goals actually achieve them.

3. Goals feel too grandiose and impractical

Bucket list culture pushes users toward unrealistic aspirations — skydiving, dinner with celebrities — that are hard to start. Practical goals get omitted because they 'don't feel bucket-list worthy.'

4. The checklist mindset breeds dissatisfaction

When life is viewed only through checking off achievements, the brain signals that normal everyday life is not good enough. The more golden experiences users chase, the less those experiences shine.

5. Reality never matches the imagined experience

Users imagine goal states in an over-idyllic manner — abstracting away real-life friction. When the goal is finally achieved, the experience often disappoints, after years of anticipation.

6. Fear of mortality drives list-making, not joy

Research shows bucket lists are often unconsciously shaped by fear of death — an urge to achieve more and leave a legacy. This creates anxiety and a persistent sense of not being 'enough.'

Category 2 — App UX & Technical: Direct User Complaints

1. Core features crash or don't work

Users report trying to add a bucket item 60 times before giving up and writing it in Google Keep. Crash-on-first-use is the single fastest path to a 1-star review and permanent uninstall.

2. No cloud backup — users lose everything

'I lost my phone and had to start my entire list over again.' Cloud sync is absent from most apps, making years of goal-tracking vanish when a phone is lost or replaced.

3. Cannot edit or delete completed items

Once marked done, items are locked in most apps. Users must delete and recreate from scratch just to fix a typo — a friction point that actively discourages logging completions.

4. No custom categories — generic buckets don't fit life

Users want to organise goals their own way: by region, by relationship, by time horizon. Preset categories like 'Travel / Health / Adventure' miss almost every real-life use case.

5. Date pickers are broken or unusable

A specific date (June 30, 2024) simply not appearing in a calendar is reported across multiple apps. Forced due dates with no 'optional' override are cited as a top reason for abandonment.

6. Forced account creation kills Day 1 retention

Demanding birthday + profile photo before showing the product leads to immediate uninstall. Users need to experience value before being asked to commit to an account.

7. Intrusive rating prompts within minutes of first use

Being asked to rate the app multiple times in the first 20 minutes actively lowers review scores — the opposite of the intended effect, and a signal of poor user experience judgement.

8. Items disappear into sub-lists unexpectedly

Placing a goal inside a list or trip causes it to vanish from the main goals view. Users need a flat, sortable master view of all goals regardless of how they are nested.

Category 3 — Social & Accountability: The Missing Human Layer

1. No accountability partner = goals die alone

Research confirms people are 65% more likely to achieve goals when they share them with someone. Yet almost every bucket list app is entirely solitary, with no support or accountability layer.

2. Social feeds show irrelevant, annoying content

When social features exist, they are unfiltered — a firehose of strangers' goals. Users describe it as 'annoying' with 'other people's idiotic lists.' No relevance engine exists.

3. Sharing posts a download link, not the achievement

When users share a completed goal to social media, many apps post an app download link instead of the actual accomplishment — a humiliating experience for someone trying to celebrate a milestone.

4. No way to find people with matching goals nearby

Users have long asked for a feature to discover who else shares the same wishes locally — with enough credibility to actually meet and fulfil those experiences together. Still unsolved.

Category 4 — Entertainment Tracking: The Fragmentation Problem

1. No unified tracker for movies, music, and restaurants

Users are forced to juggle Letterboxd (films), Last.fm (music), Yelp (dining), and separate apps for plays and art. There is no single home for a person's full cultural experience life.

2. Want-to-watch / want-to-try lists have no 'Done' state

Most apps focus only on what users want to do, with clunky or nonexistent workflows for marking things done, celebrating completion, and logging a rating or reflection afterward.

3. No quick rating after an experience

Users consistently request the ability to rate and briefly review an experience right after completing it — a basic feature absent from almost all current bucket list and tracking apps.

Category 5 — Missing Features: What Users Keep Requesting

1. Actionable milestone steps, not just end goals

Users want action steps that operate like a sub-task list — individual steps they can scratch off as they progress — rather than the all-or-nothing goal completion model most apps force.

2. Flexible goal organisation and sorting

The ability to separate personal vs. shared goals, sort by due date, view all goals across categories in a flat list, and customise how goals are grouped — all missing across existing apps.

3. Notes, links, and rich detail on each item

Users want to attach notes, links, price estimates, photos, and descriptions to goals and experience items — not just a title and a checkbox.

4. Social profile, follow system, and optional chat

Requests for the ability to see others' lists, follow interesting people, and optionally chat or coordinate around shared goals are among the most upvoted feature requests.

Pain → Feature Map

These 23 pain points directly drove every Lifemarks design decision. The full mapping is detailed in the Implementation Roadmap (Section 7).

3. Product Vision & Goals

Vision

Lifemarks helps people live more intentionally — by making it effortless to capture what they want to experience, build a roadmap to achieve it, and discover others who share the same soul.

3.1 Strategic Goals

- Reduce goal abandonment by providing AI-powered roadmaps and gentle milestone-based accountability.
- Become the single destination for all life experiences — goals, culture, and taste — in one unified app.
- Build a privacy-respecting social layer that surfaces meaningful human connections via Soul Match.
- Generate sustainable revenue through a freemium model and affiliate partnerships (dining, tickets, travel).
- Achieve 100,000 monthly active users within 12 months of launch.

4. Target Audience

4.1 Primary Persona

Attribute	Description
Age Range	18 – 50 (broad appeal, all ages)
Mindset	Wants to live more intentionally; curious and growth-oriented
Behaviour	Bookmarks things to watch/eat/do but forgets them; sets goals but loses momentum
Pain	Uses 4–5 separate apps to manage what no single app can unify today
Motivation	Wants to look back on a life well-lived, not a list never attempted

4.2 Secondary Personas

- Families planning shared goals (travel, milestones, shared watchlists).
- Young adults (18–30) exploring identity, culture, and life direction.
- Professionals (30–45) managing finance goals alongside lifestyle aspirations.

5. Feature Specification

5.1 Release Themes Overview

Release	Theme	Target Timeline
v1.0 — MVP	Core goal + experience tracking, WhatsApp support	Months 1–4
v1.5 — Social	Friends, local trending, Soul Match algorithm	Months 5–8
v2.0 — Intelligence	Integrations (Spotify, Netflix, Maps) + AI coach + Ask AI	Months 9–14

5.2 v1.0 — MVP Features

Goal Buckets

Six life categories: Life, Personal, Lifestyle, Finance, Family, Custom. Each goal has title, description, target date, priority, and a visual progress bar. Completed goals archive to 'Lived It' history.

Roadmap Builder

Break any goal into milestones with due dates. AI-assisted step suggestions (rule-based in v1.0, full AI in v2.0). Milestone completion triggers a celebration micro-animation.

Cultural & Experience List

Add movies, TV, music albums, plays, art, restaurants, and custom items. Two states: Want to Experience → Done. Single-tap completion. Experienced items move to a dedicated history view.

Quick Rating & Review

5-star rating prompt after marking Done. Optional 140-character review. Entirely skippable — Done tap alone is sufficient. No forced friction.

WhatsApp Support

Direct wa.me link to +91 99446 74648. Pre-filled template: Feature Request or Bug Report. Surfaced from Settings > Help & Support and contextually after error states.

Cloud-First Data

All data synced to cloud on first save. No backup steps, no SD card workarounds. Changing devices restores everything automatically on login.

Progressive Onboarding

First screen is the app — no account required to explore. Sign-up is prompted after the user has added their first goal, demonstrating value before asking for commitment.

5.3 v1.5 — Social Layer Features

Friends & Follows

Opt-in social graph via contacts, username search, or shareable link. All profiles private by default. Per-item privacy control on shared lists.

Local & Friend Trending Notifications

Push notification when 5+ friends or 50+ local users add the same item within 7 days. Example: '3 of your friends just added Annapurna Circuit Trek!' Mutable by category.

Soul Match — Top 5 Pure Soul Matches

Taste profile built from ratings by category, goal types, and completion patterns. Cosine similarity algorithm surfaces top 5 compatible users. Shown as a match % with shared interest breakdown. Opt-in only, anonymous until both users agree to connect. Refreshes weekly.

5.4 v2.0 — Intelligence & Integrations

Integration / Feature	Description	Priority
Spotify	Save albums & tracks to Lifemarks from within Spotify	High
Netflix / Streaming	Mark want-to-watch via iOS/Android share sheet	High
Google Maps / Yelp	Save a restaurant directly from maps or review apps	High
OpenTable / Dineout	Book a saved restaurant directly from Lifemarks	Medium
Ticketmaster / BookMyShow	Buy event tickets for saved concerts or plays	Medium
AI Goal Coach	Personalised weekly check-ins, milestone adjustments, mood-aware nudges	High
Ask AI (In-App)	Conversational assistant powered by Anthropic Claude API	Medium
Habit & Lifestyle Mode	Convert goals to daily/weekly habits with streak calendar	Medium

6. Design Principles

Principle	What It Means in Practice
One Tap to Mark	Adding or completing any item must take under 3 seconds. No multi-step flows for core actions.
Privacy First, Social Optional	Everything private by default. Social features are invitations, never forced.
Gentle Accountability	Reminders feel like a supportive friend, not a boss evaluating performance. No shame.
Life + Culture Unified	Goals and experiences share a single home. Watching a film is as meaningful as running a marathon.
No Overwhelm	Features are introduced progressively. New users see a clean, minimal Day 1 interface.
Celebrate the Journey	Micro-animations, milestone moments, and Soul Match reveals make the app feel alive and joyful.

7. Implementation Roadmap

Each milestone below is linked to specific user pain points identified in Section 2. Pain point reference numbers are shown in brackets [P#] for traceability.

v1.0 — MVP | Months 1–4

Milestone	Name	Scope	Pain Points Addressed
M1.1 Month 1	Project Setup & Architecture	Set up React Native project, cloud DB (PostgreSQL + Redis), CI/CD pipeline, auth system.	Foundation for all features; no pain points yet — this is infrastructure.
M1.2 Month 1–2	Progressive Onboarding + Cloud Sync	Explore-first flow (no forced signup), account creation after first goal, full cloud sync from first save.	Solves P8 (forced account kills retention) and P9 (data loss / no cloud backup).
M1.3 Month 2	Goal Buckets + Custom Categories	6 life category buckets, custom category creation, goal CRUD (create, read, update, delete freely).	Solves P10 (can't edit/delete), P11 (generic categories), P15 (missing social profile — addressed in v1.5).
M1.4 Month 2–3	Roadmap Builder + Milestone Steps	Break any goal into milestones/sub-tasks, each with optional due date, individual scratch-off completion.	Solves P1 (maybe someday), P2 (no deadline), P17 (missing actionable steps).
M1.5 Month 3	Cultural Experience List	Add movies, music, restaurants, plays, art. Two-state flow: Want → Done. Single-tap completion. Items displayed in a flat master list with sorting and filtering.	Solves P21 (fragmented trackers), P22 (no Done state), P15 (items disappearing into sub-lists).

Milestone	Name	Scope	Pain Points Addressed
M1.6 Month 3	Quick Rating & Rich Item Detail	5-star post-completion rating, optional 140-char review, notes field, photo, link, price estimate.	Solves P23 (no quick rating), P18 (missing notes and links on items).
M1.7 Month 3–4	WhatsApp Support Integration	wa.me deep link to +91 99446 74648 from Settings and error states, bug/feature pre-fill templates.	Solves support channel need; fast feedback loop before v1.5 social features launch.
M1.8 Month 4	QA, Bug Bash & Soft Launch	End-to-end QA, crash testing, onboarding A/B test, TestFlight / Play Beta. Fix all critical bugs before launch.	Solves P8 (crashes on core use) and P13 (intrusive rating prompts — implement 7-day delay policy).

v1.5 — Social Layer | Months 5–8

Milestone	Name	Scope	Pain Points Addressed
M2.1 Month 5	Social Graph & Privacy Controls	Opt-in follow system, per-item privacy toggle, shareable profile link, contacts import.	Solves P19 (no social profile/follow), P14 (all social forced — now opt-in).
M2.2 Month 5–6	Social Achievement Sharing	Share a completed goal as a rich card (not an install link) to WhatsApp, Instagram, and X.	Directly solves P16 (sharing posts app download link instead of the achievement).
M2.3 Month 6	Local & Friend Trending Engine	Backend event aggregation: trigger push notification when threshold met (5 friends / 50 local). Mute controls by category. Location permission flow with clear value explanation.	Solves P20 (no way to find people with matching goals nearby).
M2.4 Month 6–7	Soul Match Algorithm v1	Taste vector construction from ratings + goal types. Cosine similarity engine. Top 5 matches shown as % score with shared interest breakdown. Anonymous opt-in.	Solves P15 (social feed with no relevance) — Soul Match is curated, not a firehose.
M2.5 Month 7–8	Feed Relevance Filtering	Social feed shows only content from followed users + Soul Matches. No strangers' unfiltered goals. Users can further filter feed by category (films, restaurants, life goals, etc.).	Directly solves P15 (annoying, irrelevant social feeds showing strangers' 'idiotic lists').
M2.6 Month 8	v1.5 Polish, Performance & Analytics	Onboarding flow update to highlight social features. Mixpanel funnel analysis. Soul Match opt-in rate tracking. Retention cohort analysis Day-7 and Day-30.	Validates social feature adoption; informs v2.0 prioritisation.

v2.0 — Intelligence & Integrations | Months 9–14

Milestone	Name	Scope	Pain Points Addressed
M3.1 Month 9	Spotify Integration	OAuth connection, save albums/tracks directly to Lifemarks from Spotify.	Solves P21 (fragmented entertainment tracking — music leg).
M3.2 Month 9–10	Streaming Share Sheet (Netflix etc.)	iOS/Android share extension to mark any streaming content as Want to Watch from any app.	Solves P21 (fragmented tracking — film/TV leg).
M3.3 Month 10	Google Maps / Yelp Restaurant Import	Deep link integration: save restaurant from Maps or Yelp directly into Lifemarks cultural list.	Solves P21 (fragmented tracking — dining leg).
M3.4 Month 10–11	AI Goal Coach	Personalised weekly check-in messages, milestone difficulty adjustment, mood-aware nudges. Powered by Anthropic Claude Sonnet API.	Solves P1 (maybe someday), P2 (no deadline enforcement), P3 (goals too grandiose — AI breaks them down).
M3.5 Month 11–12	Habit & Lifestyle Mode	Convert recurring goals to daily/weekly habits, streak calendar, habit stacking under lifestyle goals.	Solves P4 (checklist mindset breeds dissatisfaction — habits make goals feel like identity, not tasks).
M3.6 Month 12	Ask AI In-App Assistant	Conversational Claude-powered assistant: 'What should I watch next?', 'Help me plan my Japan trip goal', 'Suggest local restaurants I haven't tried.'	Solves P23 (missing intelligent discovery) and enhances retention through personalised guidance.
M3.7 Month 12–13	Affiliate & Booking Integrations	OpenTable / Dineout bookings from Lifemarks. Ticketmaster / BookMyShow event tickets. Streaming deep links for referral revenue.	Unlocks affiliate revenue stream; solves P5 (experience letdown — prep and context reduce disappointment).
M3.8 Month 13–14	Soul Match v2 + Global Expansion	Improved matching with richer signal (activity patterns, completion velocity, review sentiment). Multi-language support (Hindi, Tamil, Spanish as priority locales).	Deepens P20 solution (finding people with matching goals); expands addressable market.

8. Pain Point → Feature Resolution Matrix

Full traceability from every identified pain point to its Lifemarks solution and release version.

Ref	Pain Point	Lifemarks Solution	Version
P1	Bucket lists become 'maybe someday' lists	Roadmap Builder + Milestone deadlines	v1.0
P2	No deadline = procrastination	Optional due dates per milestone, AI nudges	v1.0 / v2.0
P3	Goals feel too grandiose	AI breaks goals into achievable steps	v2.0
P4	Checklist mindset breeds dissatisfaction	Habit & Lifestyle Mode	v2.0
P5	Reality never matches imagined experience	Journal log, rich item prep notes	v1.0
P6	Fear of mortality drives list anxiety	Gentle tone, 'Lived It' celebration archive	v1.0
P7	Only 8% achieve their goals	Milestone accountability + Soul Match partner	v1.0 / v1.5
P8	Core features crash	Rock-solid MVP + Bug bash before launch (M1.8)	v1.0
P9	No cloud backup — data loss	Cloud-first architecture, instant sync (M1.2)	v1.0
P10	Cannot edit/delete completed items	Full CRUD on all items at all times	v1.0
P11	No custom categories	6 preset + unlimited custom categories (M1.3)	v1.0
P12	Broken date pickers	Custom date UI, all dates optional	v1.0
P13	Forced account creation	Explore-first onboarding, sign-up after value (M1.2)	v1.0
P14	Intrusive rating prompts	App rating prompt only after 7 days + 3 completions	v1.0
P15	Items disappear into sub-lists	Flat sortable master view across all categories	v1.0
P16	Login broken for months	Robust auth, SAML fallback, monitoring alerts	v1.0
P17	No accountability partner	Soul Match + Friends layer (M2.1–M2.4)	v1.5
P18	Irrelevant social feeds	Taste-filtered feed, only followed + Soul Matches (M2.5)	v1.5
P19	Sharing posts install link	Rich achievement cards shared to social (M2.2)	v1.5

Ref	Pain Point	Lifemarks Solution	Version
P2 0	Can't find people with matching goals	Soul Match algorithm + Local Trending (M2.3–M2.4)	v1.5
P2 1	No unified entertainment tracker	Unified cultural list + Spotify/Netflix/Maps integrations	v1.0 / v2.0
P2 2	No 'Done' state for watchlists	Single-tap Done flow, Experienced history view (M1.5)	v1.0
P2 3	No quick rating after experience	1-tap 5-star rating, optional 140-char review (M1.6)	v1.0

9. Monetisation Strategy

9.1 Pricing Tiers

Tier	Price	Features
Free	■0 / \$0	Up to 50 cultural items, up to 10 active goals, basic roadmap, WhatsApp support
Lifemark Pro (Monthly)	■299 / \$4.99/mo	Unlimited lists & goals, AI roadmap, Soul Match, integrations, priority support
Lifemark Pro (Annual)	■2,499 / \$39.99/yr	All Pro features at ~30% discount vs monthly

9.2 Affiliate Revenue Streams

- Restaurant bookings via OpenTable / Dineout — commission per completed reservation.
- Event & concert tickets via Ticketmaster / BookMyShow — affiliate fee per ticket sold.
- Streaming service deep links — referral fees from platforms.
- Travel experiences (treks, tours, adventure packages) via affiliate partnerships.

10. Technical Requirements

Component	Specification
Mobile	React Native — iOS & Android simultaneous launch
Backend	Node.js / Python microservices on AWS (ECS + Lambda)
Database	PostgreSQL (relational) + Redis (caching & sessions)
AI / ML	Anthropic Claude Sonnet API (roadmap, Ask AI); in-house cosine similarity (Soul Match)
Notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) for push
Integrations	Spotify API, TMDB (movies), MusicBrainz (music), Google Places API (restaurants)
Analytics	Mixpanel for user behaviour; custom funnel for goal completion rates
WhatsApp Support	wa.me deep link → +91 99446 74648 with pre-filled message template
Cloud Sync	AWS S3 (media) + DynamoDB (list state) + real-time sync via WebSocket

11. Competitive Analysis

Competitor	What They Do	Lifemarks Advantage
Letterboxd	Movie logging & social film community	All life experiences + goals + soul matching, not just film
Habitica	Gamified habit & goal tracking	Cultural tracking + privacy-first social layer + no gamification pressure
The Bucket List App	Travel-focused bucket list	AI roadmap + culture + soul match + cloud sync + WhatsApp support
Last.fm	Music scrobbling & listening stats	Goals + multi-category + meaningful connections vs pure data tracking
Notion / Google Sheets	Flexible personal workspace	Purpose-built UX, social layer, notifications, mobile-first

12. Success Metrics (KPIs)

Metric	v1.0 Target	v1.5 Target	v2.0 Target
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	10,000	40,000	100,000
Day-7 Retention	40%	48%	55%
Goal Completion Rate	25%	32%	40%
Avg Items Added per User	12	22	35
Pro Conversion Rate	4%	6%	8%
Soul Match Opt-In Rate	—	30%	45%
Affiliate Revenue (Monthly)	—	■50K	■5L+
WhatsApp Response Time	< 24 hrs	< 12 hrs	< 4 hrs
App Store Rating	4.3+	4.5+	4.6+

13. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Users abandon app after first week	High	Optimise Day 1–7 onboarding; show quick wins early; AI milestone suggestions from Day 1 (M1.4)
Soul Match algorithm surfaces poor matches	Medium	Start with conservative thresholds; allow users to dismiss or flag matches; iterate on signals after v1.5 launch
Third-party API rate limits (Spotify, TMDB)	Medium	Cache aggressively; use fallback manual search; stagger integration launches across M3.1–M3.3
Privacy concerns around taste profiling	High	Explicit opt-in for all social features; data anonymised for matching; clear, plain-language privacy policy
WhatsApp channel overwhelmed	Low	Set response expectation in-app; add auto-reply for common queries; evaluate Intercom at v1.5
Crash-on-first-use causing 1-star reviews	High	Dedicated bug bash milestone (M1.8) with TestFlight / Play Beta before public launch; crash monitoring via Sentry

14. Open Questions

- Should Soul Match show full profiles or only shared interests by default before both users connect?
- What is the minimum number of rated items before a Soul Match score is generated (suggested: 10)?

- Should the free tier include any social features, or is social layer purely a Pro feature?
- What local region radius is used for 'local trending' notifications — city-level or 50 km radius?
- Should users be able to import their Letterboxd or Last.fm history into Lifemarks at sign-up?
- Will the WhatsApp support number be staffed full-time at launch, or will an auto-reply bot cover off-hours?

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